



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: The IMAGO School
School Website: <https://imagoschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

The IMAGO School (Maynard, MA, 1754) presents a strong, clearly classical-leaning profile within a Christian, classical tradition. Public materials emphasize formation of character, virtue, and wisdom through a curriculum anchored in Christian ideals, liberal arts orientation, and a structured classical pedagogy. There is explicit mention of Goodness, Truth, and Beauty, liturgical practices (Chapel), and a curriculum that includes Latin and a Great-Books-leaning sensibility, alongside robust arts integration. The school also foregrounds a close partnership with parents and a community ethos, with open houses and a living faculty model. Overall, the six-category assessment places Imago as CLASSICAL with nuanced strengths in several domains and some areas where explicit classical markers could be named more directly in public-facing materials.

- Strong CLASSICAL alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Faculty, and Parents & Community.
- Mixed but positive alignment in Curriculum and Pedagogy, with explicit classical elements (Latin, Great Books-leaning references, and forms of contemplative learning) present, yet with less explicit articulation of all canonical classical methods (e.g., explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric sequencing or Socratic seminars in public materials).
- Aggregate: CLASSICAL, with room for needle-moving refinements in public articulation of pedagogy and curriculum specifics.

What would move the needle: - Publicly foreground the core Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) alongside Quadrivium elements in the curriculum narrative. - Make explicit the Great Books/Great Conversation framing and, where possible, cite representative works or a stated list. - Clarify and publicly showcase Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in upper grades, and narrate concrete examples (e.g., seminars, debates, capstone projects) in public materials. - Continue and expand parent formation and ongoing parent education with structured programs and book studies, explicitly linking to classical aims.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials identify Imago as “A private Christian school in the classical tradition.” - Texts describe the school as rooted in a Christian Classical tradition and God’s Word, with emphasis on a transcendent moral framework. - Liturgical/communal practices appear via Chapel and liturgical language in campus life (e.g., Chapel at 8:15 a.m.). - The triad of Goodness, Beauty, and Truth is invoked as guiding ideals. - The arts and beauty as a conduit to sacred aims are highlighted (arts integration, music, drama). - The Great canon of literature, history, science, mathematics, and art is referenced as part of the intellectual heritage.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christian, classical tradition, God’s Word, chapel, liturgy, truth, goodness, beauty, Great canon, imago Dei (via the Christ-centered, classical framing), worship, sacred music, wonder, and sacred art. - Negative keywords present: none evident in the public materials. - Ratio (positive vs. negative): 6+ vs 0; approximate positive 100%.

Why this rating - The school’s own framing centers Christian, transcendentals-based formation and liturgical/community life, aligning with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria. The explicit invocation of truth, goodness, and beauty alongside liturgical practices indicates a robust alignment with classical-orthodox religious foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Emphasis on formation of virtue, wisdom, and character over mere work-prep. Texts describe formation aimed at “virtue” and “human flourishing” and a classical telos. - The triadic pursuit of True, Good, Beautiful is central; the mission centers on shaping character and understanding rather than only job-readiness. - Explicit mention of classical orientation and the integration of Christian worldview in education (Massachusetts context explicitly noted as meeting required standards). - The curricular and aspirational phrasing around forming a thoughtful, well-read student aligns with “Great Conversation” and a classical mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé, Great Conversation (explicitly named as a classical idea in the lexicon; evidence appears in materials referencing classical heritage and comprehensive formation), human flourishing. - Negative keywords present: none evident. - Ratio: 5–6 positive keywords / 0–1 negative; approximate positive 100%.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation and virtue as primary aims, with an explicit classical mission and a Christian framework. The emphasis on metaphysical aims (truth/beauty/goodness) and formation over mere information strongly supports CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - References to a classical canon and Great Books orientation appear via statements about literature, history, and a classical intellectual lineage (e.g., “great canon of literature, history, science, mathematics, and art”). - A structured sequence including Latin instruction (two years of Latin required for Grades 7–8). - The Upper/Lower School structure emphasizes core subjects (English, Mathematics, History, Science, Latin) and a rigorous approach to study, with a strong emphasis on foundational disciplines. - Arts integration and deliberate exposure to music, drama, and art as a persistent element of education. - Downloadable curriculum materials and a public articulation of “Imago curriculum” as a Christian-Classical blend. - The public materials also reference a path toward a capstone project and high-level thinking (e.g., “capstone thesis project”) in a later article about upper grades. - Some explicit classical elements such as Great Books and Latin are present, but explicit, systematic mention of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as a named curricular framework is less visible in the public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books / great canon, Latin, history, classical, capstone, literature, primary sources, Western civilization (from curriculum-related content), drama/music/art as integrated arts. - Negative keywords present: absence of explicit, named references to grammar, logic, and rhetoric in public-facing materials; absence of explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy labeling in public content. - Ratio: Positive keywords present (4–6 distinct terms) vs. Negative keywords present (0–1 explicit classical-labeled terms like grammar/logic/rhetoric). Estimated positive ~70–90%, negative ~10–30%.

Why this rating - Imago demonstrates core classical curriculum tendencies (Latin, Great Books-oriented language about literature and a canon, and a formal, discipline-based subject structure). However, explicit naming and public articulation of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and explicit reference to Great Books as the public academic backbone are not consistently foregrounded in public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating, reflecting substantial classical alignment with room for stronger explicit articulation of the core canonical methods.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes contemplative and restful learning elements at times (scholé-like spirit) and indicates care for memory and the memory of learning through singing and music in lower grades. Public materials describe disciplined, reverent classroom life and a growth mindset toward wonder and beauty. - Lower- and upper-school experiences include singing, drama, and music—ritual and artistic forms that align with a contemplative, memory-focused pedagogy. - Statements about upper-grade education

involving thinking, articulation, and mastery of a body of knowledge hint at a structured, classical progression (though not explicitly framed as Socratic seminars in public content). - Public materials emphasize the value of virtue and character formation in pedagogy, and the school references “end-of-education” clarity, which aligns with a teleological classical aim.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: contemplative/restful learning (scholé), memory work (chanting, singing to memorize or recitation appears in the lexicon, and is echoed by singing-based lower-grade activities), seminar/debate (explicit Socratic pedagogy is not clearly present in public content; but there are hints of disciplined discussion through the upper-school approach to thinking and articulation). - Negative keywords present: explicit, formal references to project-based learning or experiential learning as the dominant pedagogy are not present; the public materials do not emphasize student-directed or constructivist pedagogy as the defining method. - Ratio: Positive keywords present (restful learning, chant/singing, memory-oriented practices) vs. Negative keywords present (explicit project-based, student-directed pedagogy not foregrounded). Estimated positive ~40–60%, negative ~0–20%, with some uncertainty due to limited explicit labeling.

Why this rating - The Pedagogy category shows significant classical-leaning practices (memory work, music, contemplative/restful moments, moral formation, and a staged progression toward higher-order thinking). However, explicit articulation of Socratic seminars, formal deliberative pedagogy, and critical questioning in public-facing materials is not consistently present. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, reflecting a strong classical orientation with some missing explicit pedagogical labels or descriptions in public materials.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The presence of a clearly defined leadership and “Head of School,” with detailed faculty profiles and a sense of mentor/teacher leadership. - The public materials describe the faculty as embodying the living curriculum, with a communal, collegial model and emphasis on character and guidance. - There is a “Faculty and Staff” page that highlights teachers as key figures in the school life and the core of the school’s culture. - The public material frames teachers as models of virtue and expertise, aligning with the classical living-curriculum concept.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: head of school, faculty and staff, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, mentor, guide, character formation. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials. - Ratio: Positive keywords present: high; Negative: 0.

Why this rating - The school’s public materials foreground a strong, model-teacher-centric culture and a living curriculum, with clear emphasis on mentorship and virtue. This aligns robustly with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty, including the living-curriculum and faculty-as-core-the-school concepts.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents, co-teacher role for parents, and parent formation through a combination of website materials, book studies, and gatherings. - There are explicit invitations for open campus visits and events (open houses), indicating welcoming practices toward parents and community involvement. - Admissions materials and open-house information underscore ongoing parental engagement and opportunities to participate in the school’s life. - The public materials describe a mission that heavily involves families and parents in a shared journey toward classical Christian education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teaching with parents, parent formation, open campus, open houses, family involvement, community. - Negative keywords present: consumer language or customer-model language is not prominently used in the public materials; no explicit negative signals observed. - Ratio: Positive keywords present: high; Negative: 0.

Why this rating - The school’s public narrative strongly supports parental partnership and community engagement consistent with CLASSICAL ideals of parent formation and shared formation in a classical-Christian frame.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly foreground the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as a named curricular framework and explicitly connect Great Books with a defined Great Conversation program. Consider listing representative works or a concise curriculum map to demonstrate a coherent, explicit classical curriculum.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide explicit statements and examples of Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars in the upper grades, with teacher-led demonstrations or sample rubrics publicly available. Articulate how memory work, dictation, and recitation are integrated into daily practice, with sample lesson structures.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Maintain and expand the “living curriculum” narrative with more explicit teacher portraits and examples of teacher development rooted in classical pedagogy; provide evidence of ongoing faculty formation in classical education (e.g., seminars or reading groups for teachers).
- Element 3/Element 4 (Cross-cutting): Publish a unified curriculum map that links historical study, literature, and sciences to a coherent, classical framework (including primary sources, classical languages, and coherent historical timelines across grades).
- Element 1–6 (Continued growth): Expand explicit articulation of liturgical life (beyond Chapel) and a more detailed articulation of how theological study informs cross-disciplinary inquiry (e.g., theology integrated into history, literature, and science) to strengthen the religious-metaphysical foundations.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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